



Case Study · Fintech · Startup Scaling

From survival mode to *strategic clarity*.

How a payments startup stopped firefighting and built the foundation to scale — with **Stralchemistry**.



BACKGROUND

A B2B payments startup had cleared the hardest hurdle — early product-market fit. Transactions were processing, customers were paying, and the team had grown to 18 people. But growth had plateaued. The founders were exhausted from doing everything at once, and the business was beginning to show the fractures that come when early hustle cannot be converted into repeatable systems.

They came to **Stralchemistry** not knowing exactly what was wrong — only that something was.

PAINPOINTS

After an initial diagnostic sprint, four compounding barriers emerged:

No legible positioning

The company solved three different problems for three different segments, but couldn't clearly identify who it was for. Prospects were confused; the sales cycle dragged.

Founder-dependent revenue

Every significant deal ran through a founder. There was no repeatable pipeline, no account executive playbook, and no way to scale without cloning the CEO.

Unit economics flying blind

CAC and LTV had never been formally calculated. The team was growing headcount and ad spend without knowing which customer cohorts were actually profitable.

Strategy by consensus

Quarterly priorities were set in team-wide brainstorms. Everything was "important". Focus was absent. Energy scattered across a dozen half-finished initiatives.

THE STRALCHEMY ENGAGEMENT

Stralchemy ran a 90-day strategy reset — not a consulting report, but a working engagement. The methodology combined diagnostic workshops, executive co-working sessions, and go-to-market build-outs that the team could own immediately after.

1. Positioning Surgery

Stralchemy facilitated a two-day working session to map the competitive landscape, stress-test the value proposition, and carve out a defensible niche: compliance-heavy SMBs in regulated industries. One ICP. One message. The noise stopped.

2. Revenue Architecture

A structured sales motion was designed from scratch — pipeline stages, qualification criteria, objection frameworks, and a handoff protocol from founder-led to rep-led selling. The first AE hire had a playbook on day one.

3. Unit Economics Clarity

Stralchemy worked alongside the finance lead to build a cohort-level P&L model. For the first time, the team could see which acquisition channels generated profitable customers — and which were burning cash quietly.

4. Strategic Operating Cadence

A lightweight OKR framework replaced the consensus-driven roadmap. Monthly leadership reviews were structured around three priorities only — with a protocol for killing initiatives that missed early signals.

OUTCOMES

Focused market position

Inbound lead quality improved sharply within 60 days of the repositioning going live. Sales cycle length dropped from 47 days to 29.

Scalable sales motion

The first no-founder rep closed two enterprise deals in their third month - using the playbook built during the engagement.

Profitable growth channel

Two underperforming paid channels were cut. The recovered budget was reallocated to the highest-LTV cohort. CAC fell 41%.

Investor-ready narrative

The Series A deck was built directly from the strategy work - unit economics, market sizing, and positioning all sharpened and evidence-backed.

“Before **Stralchemistry**, we were building fast but steering blind. The engagement didn’t just give us a strategy - it gave us the operating discipline to actually execute one.”

Co-Founder & CEO, B2B Payments Startup (Identity withheld at client request)

From vision to victory—let’s craft it together.

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